

MonARCH

Install card — Arch Linux, made yours.

MonARCH has never been booted. Phases 1 and 2 are written and locally verified, but no version of Hyprland has yet parsed a line it generates. Install it in a VM or on an external drive. Not on a machine you need.

Before you start

BIOS	Setting
Secure Boot	Off. F10 at the HP splash. If the USB will not boot, it is this.
TPM	Off. Interferes with LUKS.
VT-x / VT-d	On. Claude Desktop's Cowork needs <code>/dev/kvm</code> and fails <i>silently</i> without it.
Boot menu	F9 on an EliteBook.

Three answers that are not optional

Filesystem	btrfs. bootstrap.sh refuses anything else — snapshots are the rollback plan.
Profile	minimal. No desktop environment. MonARCH is the desktop.
User	with sudo. bootstrap.sh refuses to run as root.

1 · Base Arch

Boot the Arch ISO. You land at `root@archiso ~ #` — this is a system in RAM; nothing on disk is touched yet. Check UEFI, then get online:

```
ls /sys/firmware/efi    # output = good. Empty = reboot, disable CSM
```

```
iwctl
station wlan0 connect YOUR_SSID
exit
ping -c2 archlinux.org
```

Then run the installer and work down the menu:

```
archinstall
```

Locales	Set the keyboard layout first. Wrong layout = you cannot type your own password.
Disk config	Best-effort layout → pick the right disk → btrfs → default subvolumes.
Encryption	Skip for a first test. One less thing between you and a desktop.
Bootloader	systemd-boot or GRUB. Either.
Profile	Minimal.
Audio	pipewire.
Network	NetworkManager. The default is none — you reboot with no internet.
User	Create one. Answer yes to superuser.

Read the summary screen before confirming — it names the disk it is about to erase. Then reboot and remove the installer.

2 · MonARCH

Log in at monarch login: — this is now *your* Arch, not the live ISO. No desktop yet; that is correct.

A bare console has no clipboard, so you cannot paste. Either SSH in from another machine and paste normally:

```
sudo systemctl start sshd
ip a      # then from the other machine: ssh you@thataddress
```

...or clone it, which is less typing and lets you edit files in place when something breaks:

```
sudo pacman -S --needed git
git clone https://github.com/Johnnycarriere215/MonARCH-Modern-Arch-OS
cd MonARCH-Modern-Arch-OS && ./bootstrap.sh
```

Reboot. greetd appears; log in for Hyprland.

3 · First keys

Super (tap)	Launcher — type three letters, Enter
Super + /	Every keybinding. Generated, never hand-written
Super + Return	Terminal
Super + Q	Close window
Super + C	Editor
Super + `	Dropdown terminal
Super + 1...6	Workspaces. 6 is created on demand, destroyed when empty

4 · Prove it works

```
monarch doctor      # built to be pasted back
monarch keys check
monarch theme apply parchment # whole desktop goes light
monarch mode set windows    # title bars + taskbar
monarch install monarch-code # the editor, builds from source
```

The full check list is docs/07-VM-TESTING.md §5 — twelve items, in order.

When it breaks

Install stops	The failing stage is named on screen. Keep /var/log/monarch-install.log.
AUR build fails	Expected, non-fatal. But if walker-bin failed, the Super key does nothing.
Login loops back	Ctrl+Alt+F2, then: tail -50 ~/.local/share/hyprland/hyprland.log
Black screen	Same. Almost certainly a config parse error.
Bad update	Reboot, pick the previous snapshot from the boot menu. Every update snapshots first.
Start over	VM: revert to the clean-arch snapshot. Ten seconds.

Never wipe the internal NVMe before Phase 4. Use a VM, or an external drive (docs/08-USB-INSTALL.md) and pick it with F9 at power on — the internal disk and whatever is on it stay untouched.

Paste back into the next session: the failing stage if any, monarch doctor, and which checks passed. PROGRESS.md has criteria waiting on exactly that.